

"We are perceived as exotic beauties"

After Ujjwala Raut and Laxmi Menon, another Indian model is finding her space internationally. **Diana Penty**, the face of Maybelline, will soon walk the ramp at New York Fashion Week and has already shot for Neiman Marcus and Bluefly campaigns. The 24-year-old gets talking.

Q. What have you been up to in New York?

A. I've been here for less than a month and I was only attending meetings the first few weeks since this is my first season in the city.

Q. What does the West think of Indian models?

A. We are perceived as exotic beauties. Whenever I meet clients we end up having conversations about how beautiful India is.

Q. Is the West now more open to Indians as models?

A. With Freida Pinto's success and Aishwarya Rai Bachchan becoming a known face, people have woken up to the Indian market.

Q&A

CHILD LOCK



It isn't enough that children on TV are playing lead roles, dancing, singing and even doing stand-up comedy. Now two bespectacled kids, five-year-old Afsha Musani (L) and 10-year-old Dhairya Sorecha, will be hosting *Sa Re Ga Ma Pa Li'l Champs'* new season. Like all other reality show hosts, the two will hold fort on stage, manage the contestants and banter with judges. Though Ajay Bhanwalkar, Zee TV programming head, insists shooting is held only once a week, one can't help but wonder if a five-year-old is the right choice. Children may generate TRPs but is this pressure really fair?

TENTH HOUSE

Look what Shilpa Shetty has set in motion. Now another Indian has entered the *Big Brother* house in UK. Sree Dasari, a business student at the University of Hertfordshire, is quite an entertainer in the 10th season. He's already threatened to walk out, claimed to be a virgin which was rubbished by his college mates, and him being Indian is keeping audiences glued. Super Sree, as he's known, wants to be a celebrity so he can work for charities. Really Sree? Is that the only reason?



YOGEN SHAH



QUIET A WEDDING

From acting to directing, she tried almost everything under the guidance of mentor Ram Gopal Varma. Since nothing worked, **Antara Mali** went into hibernation. Apparently, the Miss India is now Mrs after marrying magazine editor Che Kurien. No one even has a whiff of the romance and the secret ceremony. Wonder if Ramu knew?

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